

JETRO Business Brief 2026/08/24

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****ASIA-OCEANIA****

People's Bank of China announces reform and development policies for the 15th Five-Year Plan period, promoting innovation support and internationalization of the yuan (China)

China AIIA holds 18th plenary meeting to promote industrial application of AI technology (China)

China's National Data Administration promotes international cooperation on data, designates 10 pilot regions (China)

VW Anhui's 100,000th smart EV rolls off line, strengthening China-based development and production system (China)

Swiss automotive parts giant Berghahn starts operations at R&D center and new factory in Wuhan (China, Switzerland)

Hong Kong government revises 2026 full-year GDP growth outlook upward to 3.5-4.5% (Hong Kong)

Hong Kong Chief Executive meets with ASEAN Secretary-General, emphasizing deepening economic cooperation and mutual benefit (Hong Kong, China, ASEAN)

Bangladesh to change fiscal year from July-June to April-March starting 2028 (Bangladesh)

New president assumes office in Bangladesh, cabinet reshuffle conducted following Rahman administration (Bangladesh)

****NORTH AMERICA AND LATIN AMERICA****

Trump administration imposes additional tariffs on Canada, first measure under Section 338, casting shadow on USMCA outlook (US, Canada)

Canada's trade negotiations with US collapse, retaliatory measures effective September 8 (Canada, US)

Trump administration announces "National Science and Technology Strategy," outlining trade measures to maintain superiority (US)

SB Energy, NVIDIA, and OpenAI announce collaboration details in Ohio (US)

Antolo Energy establishes high-performance polymer electrolyte manufacturing facility in Kentucky (US)

US provisional antidumping tariffs on Mexican strawberries draw concerns from Mexican economy ministry and industry groups (Mexico, US)

Chilean foreign minister confirms strengthened relations with China during visit, urges Chinese business leaders to increase investment (Chile, China)

****EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA, AND CAUCASUS****

Spanish government extends Almaraz nuclear plant operation license until June 2030, partially revising 2027-2035 nuclear phase-out schedule (Spain)

High-level dialogue hosted by UNDP in Uzbekistan discusses Japan cooperation on urban resilience (Uzbekistan, Japan)

Kazakhstan holds first parliamentary election under new constitution, ruling party expected to secure parliamentary majority (Kazakhstan)

****MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA****

OPEC revises down 2026 global oil demand outlook, revises up 2027 outlook (Middle East, World)

German-backed MAN resumes commercial vehicle assembly in Algeria, Chinese companies also increasing activity (Algeria, Germany, China)